

# METAPHOR

Saying one thing **IS** another thing



## 1 What is it?

**Metaphor** (MET-uh-for)

A metaphor describes something by saying it **IS** something else entirely — no "like" or "as" — to make a comparison feel bold, direct and total.

**thing A + IS / WAS + thing B**

## 2 See it in action

Describing time

Time is a thief, stealing moments you can never get back.

Describing a person

My little brother is a tornado when he enters a room.

Describing emotion

Her heart was a block of ice after the argument.

In everyday speech

"The classroom was a zoo" — total chaos, not literal animals.



**Look here!**

Ask yourself: "Is the writer literally saying this thing **IS** something else?" If yes, and there's no "like" or "as" in sight, you've found a metaphor.

### FUN FACT

An "extended metaphor" runs through a whole paragraph, poem or even a whole book — like when a writer compares an entire life to a journey, using roads, maps and destinations throughout.

### 3 Why writers use it

**Metaphor helps writers:** make a comparison feel total and immediate — there's no "like" softening it — which makes writing feel bolder, more emotional, and more memorable.

Because a metaphor claims something *IS* something else, it forces the reader to imagine the full comparison at once, rather than just a similarity.

### 4 Don't mix it up!

#### Metaphor

- No **like** or **as**
- "The world **is** a stage."
- Says one thing *IS* the other

#### Simile

- Uses **like** or **as**
- "The world **is like** a stage."
- Says two things are *similar*



#### Watch out!

Don't confuse a metaphor with a literal statement! "The sun is a star" is a scientific fact, not a metaphor. A metaphor compares two things that are **not literally the same**.



#### You got this!

A great exam trick: metaphors are often **stronger and bolder** than similes because there's no "like" softening the comparison. Mention that boldness in your analysis for extra marks.

### 5 Quick recap

Says something **IS**  
something else

No **like** or **as**

Feels bold and direct



#### Good spot!

Try writing your own extended metaphor — pick one idea (like "school is a battlefield") and carry it through 2–3 sentences using matching vocabulary (battle, survive, retreat).